A S T A N A I T U N I V E R S I T Y
School of Digital Public Administration

Assignment 3

Photo Essay: How Customer, AI and Data Systems Are Reshaping Ferrero and Bayan Sulu

Business Administration · Year 1, Trimester 1

AI and Business

2nd attestation

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Company A: Ferrero Group · Company B: JSC Bayan Sulu

Claim: *AI can help Bayan Sulu reach Gulf families faster, but only if a named person checks every AI suggestion and customer data is used with consent.*

Introduction

My Company A is Ferrero, an international company [15]. Ferrero also uses modern technologies, including AI [8]–[10].

My Company B is Bayan Sulu, a local Kazakhstani confectionery company that started operating in Kostanay in 1974 [2].

I believe Bayan Sulu can adopt some of Ferrero's practices, especially in using AI.

Company A and Company B



	Ferrero (Company A)	Bayan Sulu (Company B)
Reach	170+ countries [15]	14 countries [2]
Revenue	€19.3B, FY 2025 [15]	51.79B ₸, 2025 [3]
Customer data	Consumer data platform in Google BigQuery [8]	Mostly distributor sales
AI in marketing	7 million AI-designed Nutella labels [9]	Little AI with customers; automation mainly in the factory [2]
AI in planning	Demand forecasting with Alloy.ai (Ferrero USA) [10]	Monthly sales plans (my assumption, Week 5)

Visual 1. *"Photo of a Bayan Sulu shop, Sauran St., Astana (own photo, 18 Oct. 2026 [11]) next to my table comparing Ferrero and Bayan Sulu. Sources: [2], [3], [8]–[10], [15]"*

I took this photo when I visited a Bayan Sulu shop in Astana. Its main value is the trust it has built with customers. The company exports to 14 countries and earned 51.79 billion ₸ in 2025 [2], [3].

Customer and Value



Visual 2. *"Photo of Bayan Sulu gift boxes and loose sweets with prices in tenge. Source: own photo, 18 Oct. 2026 [11]"*

In Gulf countries, most customers are not familiar with the brand. A family might choose a Ferrero gift box because they already trust its quality. That is why Bayan Sulu needs strong marketing to build trust in these markets.



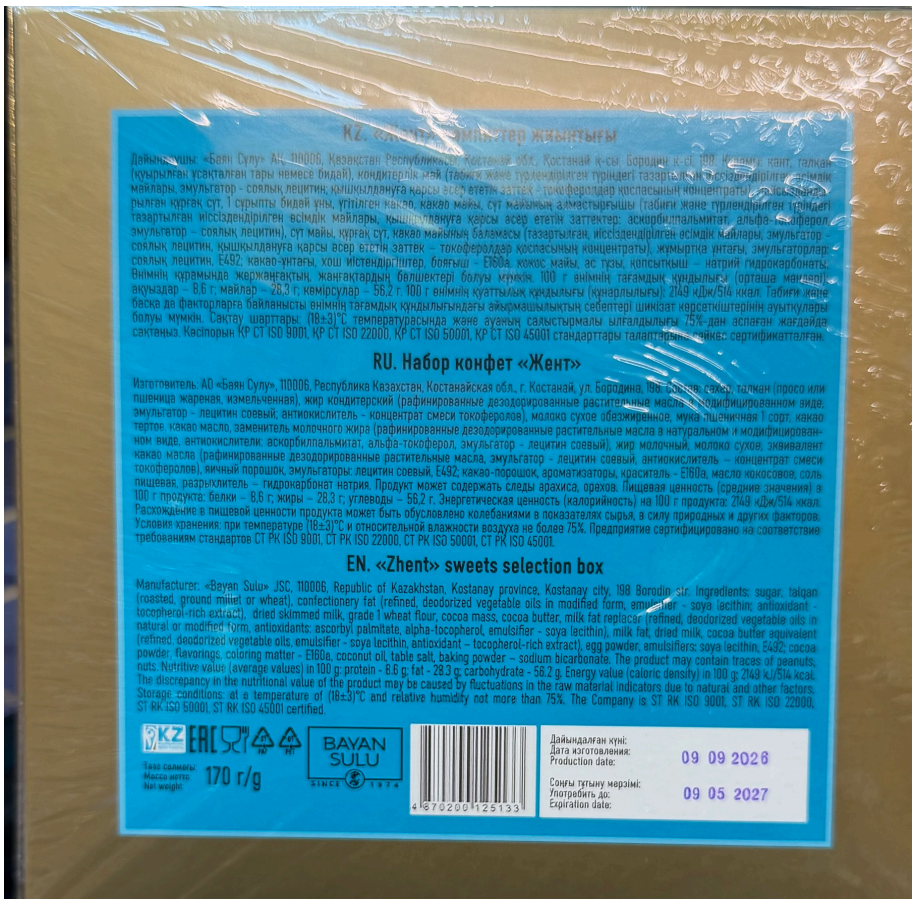
Bayan Sulu Confectionery Captivates Gulfood - 2026 and Expands into New Markets

30 january 2026

Bayan Sulu Confectionery, part of KazFoodProducts, participated in the world's largest food exhibition, Gulfood 2026, held in Dubai from January 26 to 30. The event brought together 8 500 companies from 195 countries, showcasing 1.5 million food products. Gulfood is recognized as one of the main gateways to markets with a population of over 2 billion people, primarily in Muslim-majority countries with strong demand for halal-certified products.

Visual 3. *"Screenshot of the KazFoodProducts press release about Gulfood 2026. Source: kfp.kz [4], screenshot by author [12]"*

I chose the Gulf region because it could be a good opportunity for Bayan Sulu. In January 2026, Bayan Sulu participated in Gulfood in Dubai, its first international exhibition [4]. However, the company only reported meetings, not contracts.



Visual 4. *"Close-up photo of the back label of the "Zhent" box (Kazakh, Russian and English text). Source: own photo, 18 Oct. 2026 [11]"*

The product label has information in Kazakh, Russian, and English. However, I did not see a halal mark or any information in Arabic. This could be a problem for families looking for halal products [4]. Bayan Sulu should first provide Arabic labels and obtain halal certification.

AI-Supported Comparison

Criterion	Human-only	AI-supported
Inputs / data	Gulfood notes and partner meetings [4], shop visits, distributor advice, brand book.	Same facts plus online reviews and UAE competitor ads/prices in Arabic and English, given to a generative AI tool. No personal data.
Steps & responsible actor	Marketing manager writes the brief → one agency writes one campaign → translator translates → brand manager approves.	Marketer writes brief and prompt → AI drafts many versions per group and language → native speaker and brand manager edit and choose.
Time / resources	Hypothetical: weeks of agency and translator work; one message for everybody.	Hypothetical: drafts in hours; costs are the AI tool and reviewer time. Volume rises, review work rises too.
Expected quality	Strong brand voice and local feel, but few versions and slow to change.	Many tailored versions, but risk of off-brand tone, bad translation or invented claims.

Privacy / bias risks	Low privacy risk; one team's view of a new market may miss local taste.	No personal data in prompts; AI may miss local taste or use stereotypes; uneven quality across languages [7].
Human review & approval	Brand manager signs off the final campaign.	Mandatory: native speaker + brand manager approve every ad; quality team checks halal/label claims; approval saved with name and date. AI never publishes [5], [7].

Visual 5. *"Table from my Week 6 artifact: the same marketing task done by people only and with AI support. Source: [13]"*

In Week 6, I compared two ways of creating advertising content for Gulf families: one written by people and the other created with the help of AI. Both used the same information [1], [4].

C. Method and result

Comparison method: what input, prompt/instructions, sample or evaluation criteria did you use?
Method: one real case (Gulfood 2026 [4]) run through the 4Ps and customer journey [1]; for each item the same task was described twice – people only vs. with AI (photo essay, Visual 5). Same input for both: brand facts from [2], [4], the target segment above, and the halal/label rules.

AI instruction (illustrative): "Write 5 short ad messages for Gulf families about Bayan Sulu sweets in Arabic, English and Kazakh. Use only these facts; no health claims; mention the halal mark only if certified." **Criteria:** speed, number of versions, translation quality, brand voice, cultural fit and compliance – each row ends with a named person who checks.

Observed result or reasoned expectation (do not invent measured figures):
Reasoned expectation (no measured figures): AI does better at **speed** – many ad versions, one per group, in three languages, plus fast scanning of online reviews and competitor prices.

People do better at trust – local taste, partner meetings, halal and label rules, and the voice of a 50+ year brand [4]. Finding: AI prepares the options, a named person chooses (photo essay, Visual 6).

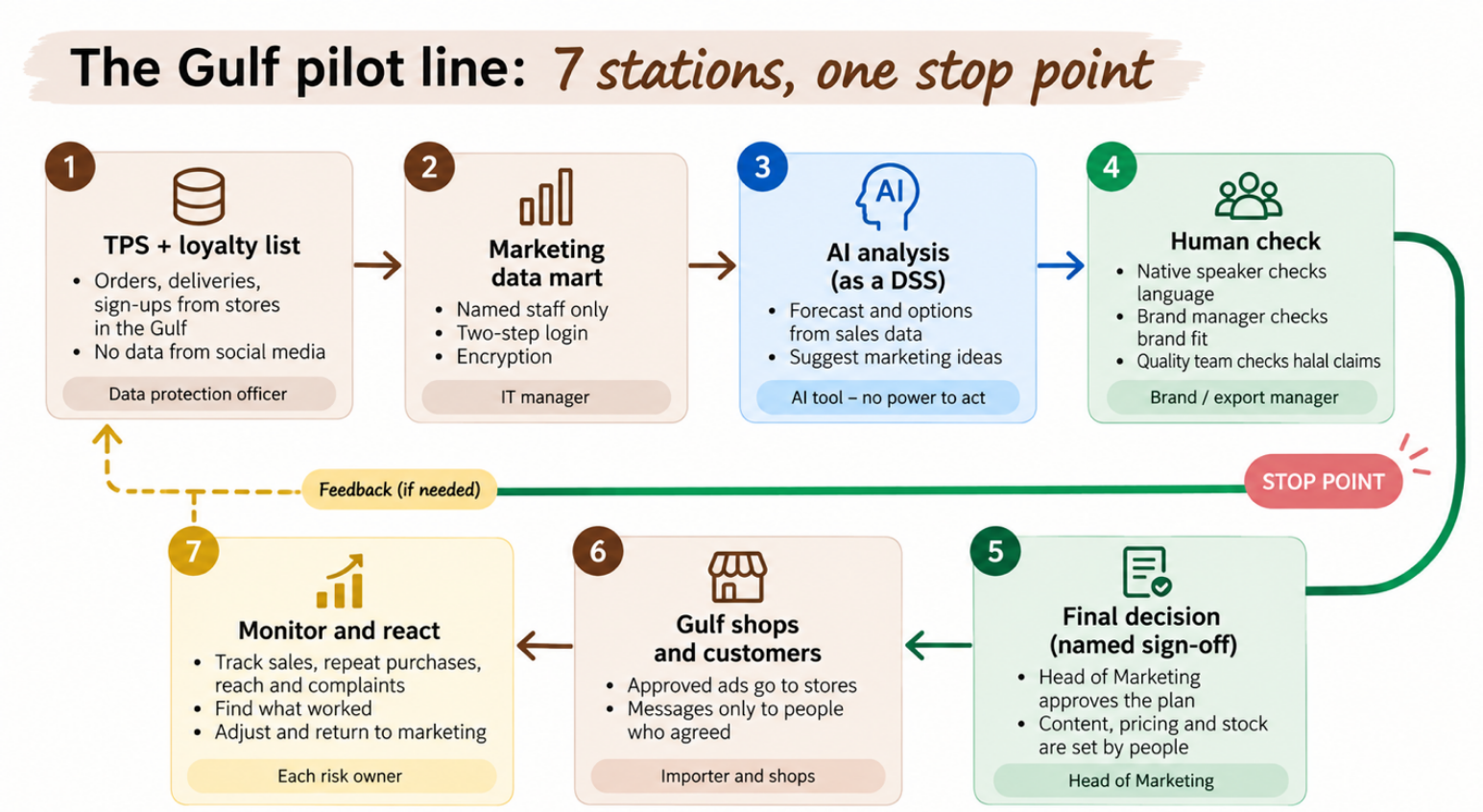
Which approach better serves the customer? What trade-off remains?
AI-supported with human sign-off better serves Gulf families: they get clearer messages in their own language sooner, and every claim is checked before it reaches them.

Remaining trade-off: speed and volume vs. accuracy and brand trust – a bad translation or a false halal/health claim could damage a brand the market does not know yet, so a native speaker and the brand manager must approve every ad [7].

Visual 6. *"Method and result section from my Week 6 artifact. Source: [13]"*

AI can save time on research, translation, and creating different versions of advertisements. People understand local tastes, customer trust, and the brand's identity better. AI should prepare the content, but a responsible person should make the final decision.

Technology, Data and Workflow



Visual 7. *"Workflow map of the Gulf pilot: 7 stations from data source to monitoring, with a stop point at the human check and a feedback line. Diagram drawn by the author in Canva, based on my Week 7 artifact [14]"*

Sales information is collected in the Transaction Processing System (TPS). It is transferred to a marketing data mart. AI uses this information to suggest ideas. The Head of Marketing must always approve the final decision [1].

Human review: who approves what, and using which criteria?
Native speaker + brand manager approve every ad: correct meaning, brand voice of a 50+ year brand, no health claims, no stereotypes. **Quality team** approves every halal/label claim: only claims backed by a valid certificate.

Export manager approves the stock plan: forecast compared with real distributor orders. **Head of Marketing** gives the final named sign-off; no name on a decision → the campaign pauses (photo essay, Visual 9).

Escalation for uncertain/high-risk cases; manual fallback for outages:
Escalation: uncertain or high-risk cases (a halal or health claim, a customer complaint, missing consent, a forecast far from real orders) go risk owner → Head of Marketing; AI never decides about a customer alone [5].

Manual fallback: if the AI tool or data mart is down, or forecast error is over 25% for 2 months, plan from distributor orders and an offline customer list, and use the Week 6 human-only route (agency + translator) for ads. Thresholds are the author's proposals, not company data.

Visual 8. *"Human review, escalation and fallback from my Week 7 artifact. Source: [14]"*

Before an advertisement is published, a native speaker checks the language. The quality team also checks any halal claims. According to the 2026 law, fully automated decisions are not allowed [5].

Governance and Risk

C. Governance risk register — at least two substantive risks

Risk and affected data	Likelihood / impact	Control + owner	Monitoring / evidence
Privacy – customer data used without consent, or public posts reused for ads. Data: loyalty sign-ups (contact, language, emirate).	Likelihood: Medium. Impact: High – legal breach under 2026 rules [5] and loss of trust in a new market.	Use only consented sign-ups; never take data from social media; no personal data in AI prompts. **Owner: Data protection officer.**	Consent log; complaints register. Trigger: any complaint or missing consent → stop using that data, review within 48 h.
Reliability – wrong forecast, bad translation, or an ad with a false halal/health claim. Data: TPS sales, AI ad drafts.	Likelihood: High (new market, little sales history). Impact: High – wasted stock or a misleading claim.	Forecast compared with real orders; native speaker + brand manager approve every ad; quality team checks claims [7]. **Owner: Export manager.**	Monthly forecast-error report; approval log. Trigger: error > 25% for 2 months → plan from distributor orders.

Visual 9. *"Governance risk register from my Week 7 artifact: privacy and reliability with their controls. Source: [14]"*

The risk that worries me most is privacy, because personal data misuse could damage customer trust. The company should only use customer data collected with consent and review any privacy complaints within 48 hours [5], [6]. Another risk is AI reliability. If AI makes mistakes and the error stays above 25%, the company should return to manual planning [7].

Comparison, Transfer and Recommendation

Action	What Bayan Sulu should do	Why
ADOPT	AI review and price scanning for research	Cheap and low risk before entering the Gulf
ADAPT	Ferrero's customer groups in Google BigQuery [8]	Start with simple groups from distributor sales, with consent
PILOT	AI demand forecasting, like Ferrero USA with Alloy.ai [10]	One product line and one UAE channel first
DELAY	Ferrero's 7 million AI-designed Nutella labels [9]	Expensive; Gulf families must know the brand first
REJECT	Prices that change automatically	Families could feel cheated; banned as a fully automated decision [5]

Visual 10. *"Table of recommendations for Bayan Sulu, based on my Week 6 artifact, Section D [13]. Ferrero practices: [8]–[10]"*

Ferrero has much more customer data than Bayan Sulu [8]–[10]. I would recommend using AI to understand different customer groups and testing AI for sales forecasting. I would not allow AI to set prices automatically [5].

Conclusion

I recommend that Bayan Sulu start with a small AI pilot in the Gulf, where AI helps prepare marketing content, but a responsible person makes the final decision. I would measure its success by tracking sales per store and repeat purchases.

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[12] A. Saginayeva, screenshot of [4], Oct. 16, 2026 (Visual 3).

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